



Alok Kejriwal
CEO, Contests2Win.com

"Iwould not say that we do SMS marketing, but yes we are involved in mobile marketing. We mainly do pull marketing. Here we advertise using the conventional methods of print, TV, etc, and give a number for interested customers to respond to.

This method of marketing is very effective. In fact, one of our success stories is the Manhattan cards project which we did for Standard Chartered bank. The entire campaign ran on 8558, and was very successful.

As far as conversions are concerned, I cite the example of Aviva Life Insurance. Because of mobile marketing, they have been able to get 200 leads a day, which would be quite impossible otherwise.

More recent examples are the figures available for Indian Idol—American Idol got 30,000 fewer responses than Indian Idol! This proves that Indians are more than willing to participate.

The mobile phone enables one to one communication with the customer—certainly an advantage to businessmen. This form of marketing is certainly more cost-effective than the conventional advertising mediums. Responding to an SMS short code is much less of a hassle than writing a letter, for example.

TING EFFECTIVE?



Viren Popli
Senior Vice President,
Wireless, STAR India

"Using the mobile phone as a medium of marketing means providing some benefits to the end consumer. This could mean the ability to respond (votes, polls), interact, participate (Contests), download (ringtones, games), etc, based on our shows. STAR also provides its many clients with interactivity. We do this by enabling their advertising through 7827.

Many of our customers only use SMS as a return path for generating leads. Organisations that are so driven in this direction would confirm that well-designed and integrated interactivity works, and works well.

As this is a personal medium, we try and individualise the responses, keeping in view the activity, the potential customer profile and similar factors. The advantages are that it is personal, direct, confidential, immediate and digital!

This service is cost-effective and efficient, as it allows you to target the potential customer without the attendant wastage. Also, it makes your other media work harder to allow you to deliver specific results.

Most marketers use it for spam, which is wrong. They miss out on the interactivity of the medium and all the attendant benefits. Since we do not spam on the mobile platform, we do not have mailing lists. Our whole service runs based on delivery of solicited information only. We do not give mailing lists nor support such ideas even from our clients.



Harit Nagpal
Chief Marketing Officer,
Hutch

"We believe that unsolicited communication, including SMSes, invade the privacy of our users and is tantamount to spamming. We do not have tie-ups with any corporate or political bodies to sending bulk messages to our subscribers, and do not intend to do so for any consideration.

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